



United States
Attorney's Office
Eastern District of Virginia



Virginia Beach doctor agrees to \$625,000 False Claims Act settlement

Thursday, January 2, 2025

For Immediate Release

U.S. Attorney's Office, Eastern District of Virginia

NORFOLK, Va. – Dr. Scott Saffold, of Virginia Beach, and his practice, Chesapeake Bay, ENT, P.C. (Chesapeake Bay), located in Belle Haven, have agreed to pay \$625,000 to settle a civil fraud case that claimed Dr. Saffold and his medical practice engaged in the routine and systematic practice of falsely billing government health care programs.

The United States and the Commonwealth of Virginia alleged that Saffold and Chesapeake Bay billed federal and state payors for balloon sinus dilations that were not medically necessary. The government alleged that Saffold and Chesapeake Bay performed these surgeries on six sinuses for many patients even when there was no medical indication of need in some or all dilated sinuses. The government further alleged that Saffold and Chesapeake Bay staged these procedures, performing each side at separate times, to increase reimbursement from government payors and without any medical justification. The government also alleged that Saffold and Chesapeake Bay routinely billed government payors for endoscopies with sphenoid sinusoscopy under Current Procedural Terminology Code 31235 when they were not actually performing that code.

The settlement arises in connection with a lawsuit filed under the whistleblower provision of the False Claims Act. A whistleblower suit, or *qui tam* action under the False Claims Act, is commenced by an individual filing a complaint under seal in the U.S. District Court and providing a copy of the complaint and evidence to the U.S. Attorney's Office. The United States then has an opportunity to investigate the claims. The False Claims Act provides whistleblowers with a share of the government's recovery.

The resolutions obtained in this matter were the result of a coordinated effort between the U.S. Attorney's Office for the Eastern District of Virginia; Health and Human Services Office of Inspector General; Department of Defense Office of Inspector General, Defense Criminal Investigative Service; and the Commonwealth of Virginia's Office of the Attorney General.

The matter was handled by Assistant U.S. Attorney Clare Wuerker and Senior Assistant Attorney General Kristin Gray and Assistant Attorney General Airen Adamonis from the Virginia Medicaid Fraud Control Unit.

A copy of this press release may be found on the website of the [U.S. Attorney's Office for the Eastern District of Virginia](#). Case records may be found on [PACER](#) under case number 2:18cv435.

The civil claims settled are allegations only; there has been no determination of civil liability.

Contact

Press Office
USAVAE.Press@usdoj.gov

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Topic

HEALTHCARE FRAUD

Component

[USAO - Virginia, Eastern](#)

Related Content

PRESS RELEASE

U.S. Attorney’s Office announces charges against three defendants in the Eastern District of Virginia as part of national health care fraud takedown

The U.S. Attorney’s Office for the Eastern District of Virginia announced charges against three defendants as part of the Department of Justice’s 2026 National Health Care Fraud Takedown.

June 23, 2026

PRESS RELEASE

Victim Advisory- Divine Youth Case Updates

In January and February 2026, charges were filed against four defendants who allegedly operated a scheme to defraud Medicaid through a mental health agency known as Divine Youth Counseling, LLC.

March 11, 2026

PRESS RELEASE

Federal jury convicts North Chesterfield man for billing Medicaid for services he did not provide

A federal jury convicted George Nathaniel Boykins, 43, of North Chesterfield, today on charges of health care fraud and aggravated identity theft.

December 15, 2025



Eastern District of Virginia

Justin W. Williams United States Attorney's

